The third milestone is careers. Modi speaks of Mudra loans to over 16 crore women as the centrepiece of his idea of self-empowerment. As he told the BJP's Mahila Morcha workers in 2018, 'Our country's daughters can now make their own careers, fulfil their dreams themselves … Without bank guarantees, people have been given loans over ₹5 lakh crores. It is a very important thing that 70 per cent of those who have got financial help from Mudra scheme are women and our daughters. I feel proud hearing this. The success of this scheme proves how our country's women are breaking old chains and coming forward for self-employment.'[118] Women also accounted for as much as 81 per cent of all financial beneficiaries (who received over 20,000 crore cumulatively in sanctioned loans) under the Stand Up India scheme between April 2016 and March 2020.[119]

The fourth peg is old-age support. Women across India accounted for 43 per cent of new pensioners (93 lakh of 2.15 crore subscribers) under the Atal Pension Yojana. Launched in May 2015, this guaranteed minimum monthly pensions of up to ₹5,000 for those above sixty years of age.[120] Women also accounted for over 40 per cent of beneficiaries under both the Pradhan Mantri Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana (PMJJBY) and the Pradhan Mantri Suraksha Bima Yojana (PMSBY).[121] Both schemes were launched in 2015. PMJJBY offers life insurance of ₹2 lakh for a premium of ₹330 per annum, while PMSBY provides accident/disability insurance of up ₹2 lakh for a premium of ₹12 per annum. Modi's speeches often highlight the fact that both these schemes provided security cover for women for just 90 paise per day (life insurance) and Re 1 per month (accident insurance). As he put it, 'If you see all these decision and schemes from a broader perspective and from a big canvas, you will find how our government understands the little-little needs of our women, daughters and sisters, understands their worries and is standing with them at every milestone and turning point in the lives of our daughters.'[122] By mid-2019, as many as 25 million women account-holders had signed up for the life insurance scheme (62.8 million Indians enrolled in all). Furthermore, a whopping 66.2 million women signed up for the accident insurance policy (a staggering 165.5